Board 1
East Deals
None Vul

♠ A K J
♥ K 7 3
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 8 6 4

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 9 8 6 2
♦ Q 7
♣ 7 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣J. East wins ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥s in your hand.

The ♦Q was not a Threat card yet: to make it a Threat you had to unblock dummy's ♦A. Then you pull trumps with the ♥ A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥ 9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

West discards.

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦6 East will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 2
♥ 9 3
♦ A K 8 6
♣ K Q 10 6 5

♠ J 10 6 5
♥ K Q J 7 5
♦ 9 2
♣ 8 4

♠ K 9 8 4 3
♥ 10 8 6 2
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ —

♠ Q 7
♥ A 4
♦ Q 5 4
♣ A J 9 7 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♣
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♣
All Pass			

6♣ by South
Lead: ♥K

South is to play 6♣. West leads the ♥K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦s also holds the ♠K and that a squeeze will be possible.

You win the first trick and pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you rectify the count by giving up a ♥.

West takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦9 which you win with your ♦Q.

West plays low.

The key play: taking dummy's ♠A before running three rounds of ♣s.

Unblocking the ♠A to create a Threat out of your ♠Q is the Vienna Coup.

West discards.

East was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣7 and discard dummy's ♠2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥K.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 7 5 2 ♥ 8 6 4 ♦ 7 5 ♣ 6 3	
♠ 9 ♥ 10 5 3 2 ♦ Q J 9 6 4 2 ♣ 10 7		♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ 9 7 ♦ 10 8 3 ♣ J 9 8 4
	♠ 4 3 ♥ A K Q J ♦ A K ♣ A K Q 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♦Q

North's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♦Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦K.

Win the ♦K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. West discards a ♦ on the ♣Q.

Alright, so East holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. West follows suit while East follows twice, then discards 2 ♦s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦A. East must give up.

If he throws the ♣J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

Board 4
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 6 ♥ A K 8 6 ♦ 9 7 3 ♣ A K Q J	
♠ 8 5 3 ♥ Q 10 7 2 ♦ J 10 8 4 ♣ 6 3		♠ 9 7 4 2 ♥ J 4 ♦ A 6 5 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ A K Q J ♥ 9 5 3 ♦ K Q ♣ 10 8 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♦J

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♦J. East takes the ♦A and returns the ♦2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against West. If it should happen that West also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze West.

On the last 2 ♣s West discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while West follows suit three times.

It is time.

West discards the ♥7, holding on to the ♦10.

Play your ♠J and watch what West discards.

If he holds on to the ♦10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦9 and hope the ♥s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 10 7 5	
♠ 7 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 6	N W E S	♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ A 8 4 2 ♦ 5 ♣ K 9 4 2
	♠ 9 3 ♥ K Q ♦ A K Q J 9 3 ♣ Q 8 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6NT by South
Lead: ♥J

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥J. East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

West plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

West discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

East is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ K 9 8 6 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K Q 5	
♠ Q J 10 6 4 ♥ 10 ♦ 10 9 7 4 2 ♣ 8 2	N W E S	♠ A 8 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q 8 3 ♣ J 10 9 3
	♠ K 7 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

West discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.